
Tim Hewitt

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate · Studying for the Professional certification

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Twenty years of client-facing work, first on superyachts and then as a coach running consultations and client programs, now moving into cloud. I design, build and deploy my own AWS systems, including one live on the iOS App Store, and write up the architecture decisions, failures and costs behind each one. I am looking for an entry-level role in the cloud industry, either technical or client-facing.

Core Competencies

Technical	AWS (VPC, ECS Fargate, Lambda, DynamoDB, ElastiCache, S3, CloudFront, API Gateway, Cognito, CloudWatch) · CloudFormation · AWS SAM · Terraform · CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions) · Docker · Python (beginner) · Bash · Linux command line and SSH
Other	Client consultations and proposals · Cloud cost analysis · Architecture decision records · Technical documentation · Team mentoring · Cross-cultural communication

Professional Experience

Senior Coach & Staff Mentor

2021 – Present

5th Element Wellness, Melbourne

- Run consultations with prospective clients: find out what they need, propose a program and explain it in plain terms so they commit to it.
- Write individual plans and keep clients following them over months, adjusting as their circumstances change.
- Mentor and train the coaching team so service stays consistent across coaches.
- Analyse membership data to inform class scheduling and advertising spend.

Bosun / Deck Crew

2006 – 2019

Superyacht industry, international

- Thirteen years of client service and maintenance tasks, where problems had to be solved in person and straight away.
- Led deck crews in high-pressure operations where safety and precision were essential.
- Worked daily with international crews and guests.

AWS Projects · [timtimtim87.github.io](https://github.com/timtimtim87)

Beige: Chess Tactics Trainer (iOS, live)

Cognito, Lightsail, Lambda, DynamoDB, Terraform

- **Live on the iOS App Store.** Designed a two-plane architecture that separates an anonymous, latency-critical read plane (Lightsail container serving a 2.95M-puzzle SQLite catalog) from a low-volume per-user write plane (API Gateway with a Cognito JWT authorizer, six Lambdas, DynamoDB).
- Built the data pipeline: re-tagged the full Lichess puzzle dataset by replaying each solution with python-chess to derive motifs, pawn structure and game phase, instead of relying on crowd-sourced tags.
- Costed Lightsail against Fargate with an ALB and chose Lightsail, cutting the planned always-on cost from about \$40/month to about \$10/month.
- Built CI/CD on GitHub OIDC (no long-lived AWS keys), five required PR checks, and automatic deploys with a live post-deploy smoke test.
- **Diagnosed a production stale-deploy incident** that silently returned empty results by comparing live and local API responses, then wrote the smoke test that now blocks the same failure.

ChessChat: Real-Time Video Chess Platform

Terraform, ECS Fargate, Redis, DynamoDB, Cognito, CloudFront

- Designed a three-tier VPC across three Availability Zones (public, private app, private data), with security groups allowing traffic only from internet to ALB to Fargate to Redis.
- Split the application across two hosts: CloudFront and S3 for the static sign-in site, and ECS Fargate behind an ALB for the authenticated gameplay runtime, all in modular Terraform.
- Kept live game state in Redis, with a background finalisation queue that saves each completed game to DynamoDB in one transactional write regardless of move count.
- Built PR-gated CI (backend, frontend and Terraform checks required on main, no admin bypass) with OIDC-authenticated deploys, plus CloudWatch alarms and eight custom application metrics.
- **Analysed a \$212/month AWS bill** and found that VPC interface endpoints bill per Availability Zone, accounting for \$89 of it. Documented the fixed and variable costs of running it.

Stock Screener & Telegram Bot

Lambda, EventBridge, API Gateway, S3, Parameter Store, AWS SAM

- Built a serverless pipeline that screened about 750 Russell 1000 stocks each morning against a custom strategy and returned ranked results and portfolio positions on request through a Telegram bot.
- Chose each service to fit the workload (Lambda over EC2, S3 over RDS, Parameter Store over Secrets Manager), keeping AWS charges under \$1/month.
- Stored API credentials in Parameter Store with IAM scoped to a single parameter path, and rejected bot requests from unrecognised Telegram chats.
- **Diagnosed a silent failure:** a lapsed data subscription let the job report success on zero records. Specified the data validation and CloudWatch alarm needed to catch it.

SUDOKOO: AI Sudoku Scanner

Amazon Bedrock, Lambda, API Gateway, CloudFront, S3

- Built a serverless web app that turns a photo of a printed Sudoku into a playable game, using Amazon Bedrock (Claude) to extract the grid.
- Designed the architecture: CloudFront and a private S3 bucket with Origin Access Control for the site, API Gateway and Lambda for scanning, and a backtracking solver to validate each result.
- Measured a success rate of about 50% from CloudWatch logs, identified the two failure modes, and listed the security and reliability work a production version would need.

Certifications & Education

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate

2026

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional (in progress)

Certificate IV in Fitness

2021

Year 12 · Guilford Young College, Hobart

2005